

Glossary



amphibians

Cold-blooded animals that live both on land and in water, such as frogs and newts

birds

Warm-blooded animals that are covered in feathers and have a bill, many of which can fly, such as eagles

climate

Normal weather pattern during the year in any part of the world

coniferous tree

Type of tree with cones and needlelike leaves that keeps its leaves all year round

continents

Seven large areas of land that the world is divided into: Africa, Antarctica, Asia, Australasia, Europe, North America, and South America

coral reefs

Rocklike structures formed by coral animals in the shallow waters along coasts

deciduous tree

Type of tree that loses its leaves in the fall or the dry season

desert

Dry region that gets very little rainfall in a year. Deserts can be hot or cold

endangered

Word used to describe a species of plant or animal with only a few living members left

equator

Imaginary line around the middle of the Earth

extinct

Word used to describe a plant or animal species that has no living members

fish

Cold-blooded animals that live in water and have gills and fins, such as salmon

habitat

Environment in which an animal or plant lives

hibernation

Sleeplike state some animals enter in winter

invertebrates

Cold-blooded animals without a backbone, such as insects, spiders, or squids

island

Piece of land that has water all around it

mammals

Warm-blooded animals that have hair and feed their young with milk, such as mice

mangroves

Trees that live in salty water and have long, stiltlike roots

marsupial

Type of mammal that keeps its young in a pouch

migration

Movement of a large number of animals from one area to another. Animals migrate to follow warmer weather and to find food

mountain

Area of land that rises up much higher than the land around it to form a peak

national park

Area of countryside that has been preserved in its natural state by the government of a country to protect the wildlife there and for people to enjoy

native

Word used to describe an animal that comes from a particular area or country

nocturnal

Word used to describe animals that are awake during the night

ocean

Very large sea. There are five oceans: the Pacific, Atlantic, Indian, Arctic, and Southern

plain

Area of flat land with few trees, often covered with grass

plateau

Large area of high, flat land

polar regions

Areas within the polar circles. Polar regions are covered in snow and ice for most of the year and are extremely cold

predator

Animal that hunts other living animals for food

prey

Animal that is hunted for food

rain forests

Dense forests with very high rainfall. Most are near the equator and are also very hot

reptiles

Cold-blooded animals covered in dry, scaly skin such as snakes, tortoises, and crocodiles

scrubland

Area of land covered in different types of grass, and small trees and bushes

species

Particular group of animals or plants that share similar features

taiga

Area of cold, coniferous forest found near the Arctic Circle

temperate grassland

Large areas of grass found in regions with hot and cold seasons, such as prairie, steppe, and pampas

temperate regions

Areas with hot and cold seasons found between tropical and polar regions

tropical grassland

Large areas of grass found in areas that are hot all year round, such as savanna and cerrado

tropical regions

Areas that are hot all year round, found near the equator between the Tropic of Cancer and the Tropic of Capricorn

tundra

Cold, treeless plains found near the Arctic Circle

wetlands

Land with wet, spongy soil, such as a marsh or swamp